

Hurting the environment isn't AI's biggest issue.

Posted by u/Katzzye • 0 points • 2 comments

It's that we become less creative and use our brains less. Scrolling Reels takes water. Watching a movie on Netflix? Also takes water. While this is definitely also an issue with AI, it's not the primary issue. AI is a tool. You use it for questions hard to Google, not for venting or stuff like that. Horrible for the environment, but even worse for the brain. Posting stuff online also takes water. But again, it absolutely is an issue with AI. But watching Netflix doesn't make you incapable of doing other things yourself.

Comments

u/Kraegorz • 0 points • 2025-09-02 18:29 UTC

Water?

You do realize that the water is like water in a cooling system. It's repumped into the system to cool. It isn't "used up" like gas. And even if the AI system was hot enough, it would evaporate the water, which would go back up into the ecosystem and come back as rain (as learned in 3rd grade science).

The only thing harmful to the environment is electricity usage (which could be negated by nuclear energy) and land usage if put in an environmental setting where they would have to destroy nature to create the buildings.

Please don't tell me people are stupid enough to believe that AI is "fueled" by water like a car is fueled by gas.

u/LegalAssassin13 • 1 points • 2025-09-03 04:16 UTC

The issue is that by using up so much water, it affects nearby communities. People who live near data centers have gone public complaining about the lack of water pressure, the silt content, and being billed for use when it's not them using that much.

Even if we disregard environmental impact, it's shitty to inflict this on people who didn't ask for any of it.

u/Kraegorz • 0 points • 2025-09-03 04:34 UTC

Yeah I have an idea most of those people are lying, exaggerating or just delusional.

1. It should have no effect on water pressure as any water being pumped into a facility

would not be enough to affect nearby homes or businesses as it would have to be a part of their existing water flow system and pumped into a facility before continuing through the system then going to a home. Most data centers have their own pump systems and are not part of the major utilities pump system, they aren't taking it "from the tap" like a normal consumer is. The only way water pressure would be an issue is if a data center was using so much water per hour that they literally had 25% or more of a reservoir of water in their pipes cycling through to drain a reservoir of water at one time. (which is massive and I don't think would happen as that means more than half a datacenter would be filled with water at one time).

2. Silt? The only time this would apply is if the water being pumped back into a reservoir was SO much that it was draining 10% or more of the water per hour and pushing it back with such force that it was causing any sediment to be pushed back up. But normal utilities and water filtration systems have a lot of filters for these and are generally not affected by such. This would also mean that if they didn't have proper filtration systems in place, anytime there was more rain than normal and the reservoir had an influx of supply, there would be tons of silt in the water. The silt content would most likely be affected by things like draughts and low water supply. Also most, if not all data centers have large filtration systems on incoming water to further filter the water before it runs through their systems (as silt buildup or debris can be VERY expensive and break the system). So water coming OUT of a datacenter is usually even more clean than actually going into it.

3. Billed? Utility companies don't bill neighbors for water usage, that's what water meters are for. Unless the city or county is giving major tax breaks to the company that is using the water and then spreading the costs out to the other consumers in the area.. this just doesn't make sense. At that point its your city/county or whomever you need to target, not a data center.

u/LegalAssassin13 • 1 points • 2025-09-03 12:12 UTC

They've demonstrated how their water has been affected on the news. One woman turned her sink's faucet on all the way and only got a trickle of cloudy-looking water.

u/FlashyNeedleworker66 • 1 points • 2025-09-02 02:02 UTC

There needs to be a lot more rigorous and peer reviewed scientific study before anyone should be confident making health claims.

u/Some_Guy_Named_Gorf • 0 points • 2025-09-02 00:54 UTC

I 100% agree with this.